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United States Patent	12396775
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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System and method for positioning a tracking device

Abstract

Disclosed is a system and method for tracking an instrument. The instrument may be tracked with one or more trackable members. The trackable members may be held relative to a handle to which the instrument is attached.

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Appl. No.:	18/763585
Filed:	July 03, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240358424 A1	Oct. 31, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17185388 20210225 US 12029465 child-doc US 18763585
division parent-doc US 15886439 20180201 US 10932840 20210302 child-doc US 17185388

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A61B17/88 (20060101); A61B17/00 (20060101); A61B17/16 (20060101); A61B34/20 (20160101); A61B90/00 (20160101); B25B23/16 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A61B17/8875** (20130101); **A61B17/1622** (20130101); **A61B34/20** (20160201);
B25B23/16 (20130101); A61B2017/00464 (20130101); A61B2017/00477 (20130101);
A61B2017/00725 (20130101); A61B17/8886 (20130101); A61B2034/2051 (20160201);
A61B2034/2055 (20160201); A61B2090/3762 (20160201); A61B2090/3983 (20160201)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61B (17/00469); A61B (34/20)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/185,388 filed on Feb. 25, 2021 which is a divisional of U.S. application Ser. No. 15/886,439 filed on Feb. 1, 2018. The entire disclosures of the above applications are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to a device holder, and particularly to a holder to position a trackable member.

BACKGROUND

(2) This section provides background information related to the present disclosure which is not necessarily prior art.

(3) In a selected procedure an instrument may be moved relative to a subject. The subject may include an external cover or shell portion and internal members or portions. The instrument may be operated to perform a procedure on the internal components while only minimally disturbing the outer shell.

(4) In performing a procedure, therefore, an instrument may be tracked with a tracking system. The tracked position of the instrument may be displayed on a display device for viewing a determined position of the instrument. The user may view the display device to determine or understand the position of the instrument relative to the subject. It may be selected, to track more than one instrument during a selected procedure.

SUMMARY

(5) According to various embodiments, a system for tracking an instrument is disclosed. The system includes a plurality of trackable members and a tracking member holder. The tracking member holder includes a chassis portion, an instrument guiding portion having an internal wall defining an instrument passage, a trackable member engagement portion configured to hold at least one trackable member of the plurality of trackable members relative to the chassis portion, and a handle engageable portion configured to hold the chassis portion relative to a handle.

(6) A system for tracking an instrument is disclosed, according to various embodiments. The system includes a tracking member holder, including (i) a chassis portion, (ii) a trackable member engagement portion, and (iii) a handle engaging portion. The system may further include an instrument handle. In various embodiments, an instrument may also be configured to be held relative to the instrument handle and moved with the instrument handle.

(7) Further areas of applicability will become apparent from the description provided herein. The

description and specific examples in this summary are intended for purposes of illustration only and are not intended to limit the scope of the present disclosure.

Description

DRAWINGS

- (1) The drawings described herein are for illustrative purposes only of selected embodiments and not all possible implementations, and are not intended to limit the scope of the present disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a tracking device holder, according to various embodiments;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the tracking device holder connected to a handle, according to various embodiments;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a perspective view of the tracking device holder connected to a handle and an instrument passing through the tracking device holder, according to various embodiments; and
- (5) FIG. 4 is an environmental view of the tracking device holder, handle, and instrument, according to various embodiments.
- (6) Corresponding reference numerals indicate corresponding parts throughout the several views of the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (7) Example embodiments will now be described more fully with reference to the accompanying drawings. Although the following is disclosed regarding an exemplary surgical procedure on a human subject, it is understood that the subject disclosure and the following claims may be directed for non-human surgical procedures and non-surgical procedure.
- (8) With initial reference to FIGS. 1, 2 and 3, a holder **10** is illustrated. The holder **10** may alone, or in combination with trackable members, form a tracking device that is trackable, as discussed herein. The holder **10** may also be referred to as a tracking device holding assembly, a tracking device holder, a tracking member holder, trackable member holder, or guide assembly. The holder **10** may allow the use of a driver or handle **54** with multiple instruments, as discussed herein, with only one or a single registration or calibration.
- (9) The holder **10** may include a body or chassis portion **14**. The body **14** may include various features or sections. The sections may include a motor or handle assembly engaging region **16** that may be generally annular or selectively shaped to engage a driver or handle. An extension or open region or member **20** may extend from the handle assembly engaging region **16**. The extension region may be generally U-shaped. A guide or passage portion **24** may extend from the extension region **20**. The guide portion **24** may include a central bore of cannula **24'** that may allow passage of an instrument, as discussed herein. The guide portion **24** may have buttresses **25** on one or more sides extending from the extension region **20** to assist in supporting the guide **24**.
- (10) The holder **10** may be formed as one piece (i.e. a single and/or unitary piece) or plurality of pieces. As discussed herein, the holder **10** may be selected to be formed of a rigid material. The rigid material may have a selected rigidity such that the holder **10** does not vary in shape or dimension during use. For example, the holder **10** maintains an initial shape during use of the holder **10** to hold tracking members **30** during use of an instrument **52** (FIG. 4).
- (11) In various embodiments, the holder **10** may be molded as a single piece of polyethylene, such as ultra-high molecular weight polyethylene, such as that used for bearing members. The material of the holder **10** may be a selected bearing material and/or a bearing material (e.g. a metal sleeve) may be provided in the bore **24'**. The holder **10** may also be formed of more than one material and/or members that are fixed together. The holder **10** may be formed entirely or partially of metal, metal alloys, polymers, filled polymers (e.g. glass filled nylon), or other appropriate materials.
- (12) The material selected for the holder **10** may further include additional properties. For example, the holder **10** may have a selected anti-slip or gripping property. The holder **10** may also be

selectively reusable and sterilizable (e.g. with gas sterilization, radiation sterilization, etc.). Also, or alternatively, the holder **10** may be disposable and only single use.

(13) The holder **10** may further include one or more positions, such as posts or projections **28**, for holding the tracking devices or trackable members **30**. For example, the tracking member **30** may include a recess or depression that engages (e.g. frictionally engages) the projection or post **28** that extends from a wing or portion **29** of the holder **10**. The wing may extend from an arm or portion of the extension portion **24**. In various embodiments, the trackable members **30** may snap to the posts **28**. The tracking member **30**, therefore, may be removably fixed to the holder **10**. The tracking member **30** may include one or more tracking members, such as a first trackable member **30a**, a second trackable member **30b**, a third trackable member **30c**, and a fourth trackable member **30d** (referred to herein collectively of tracking or trackable members or devices **30**, unless specifically referred to individually). It is understood that more or less than four of the trackable members **30** may be provided with the holder **10**. Further, the trackable members **30** may be formed as one piece with the chassis **14**.

(14) With additional reference to FIG. **4**, the tracking members **30** may be any appropriate tracking members that may be tracked by a tracking system **34**. The tracking devices **30** may be tracked by the tracking system **34**, which may be incorporated or included with a navigation system **36**. In tracking the holder **10** with the tracking members **30**, a position (including a three dimension location and orientation (e.g. 1 or more degree of freedom, e.g. six degrees of freedom)) of the holder **10** an item to which it is attached may be determined.

(15) In various embodiments, the tracking devices **30** may include members that are viewable by one or more cameras of the optical or camera localizer **38**. In various embodiments, therefore, the tracking system **32** may be an optical or light tracking system. In an optical tracking system the tracking members **30** may reflect (e.g. passive) or emit (e.g. active or LEDs) wavelengths of light that are visible or invisible (e.g. infrared wavelengths) that are detected by the cameras **38a**, **38b**. The tracking devices **30** may also or alternatively include one or more coils that may be trackable with an electromagnetic (EM) tracking system localizer. The EM localizer may include one or more coils or antennas **42** of a tracking coil array **46** that may generate a field in a navigation volume **48**.

(16) Regardless of the specific configuration or type, the tracking devices **30** may be positioned on the holder **10** to assist in tracking an instrument or tool **52**, as illustrated in FIG. **3**. Generally, the instrument **52** is able to rotate. For example, the driver **54** may include a motor that rotates the instrument **52** or the handle **54** is able to be used by the user **56** to rotate the instrument **52**. The holder **10**, however, generally holds the trackable members **30** at a selected single position relative to the handle **54** during use and for tracking.

(17) In various embodiments, the holder **10**, including the trackable members **30**, may be referred to as a tracking device. The instrument **52** may be assembled or connected to a handle or drive assembly **54**. The handle, as a drive assembly, **54** may include a motor for rotating the instrument **52**. The motor in the handle **54** may be any appropriate motor such as pneumatic motor, an electrical motor, or the like. Generally, a user **56** may hold a selected portion of the handle **54**, such as a grasping handle **58**. If the handle **54** is powered, the user **56** may depress or engage one or more control mechanisms, such as a button **60**, to cause the motor included within the driver **54** to move a chuck assembly **64**, such as rotating the chuck assembly **64** that is generally within the extension region **20**. Rotating the chuck assembly **64** may rotate the instrument **52**.

(18) In various embodiments, the instrument **52** may include an elongated shaft **66** and a working end **68**. The working end **68** may be any appropriate working end such as a tap, a screw, an awl, or any appropriate working end. Further, the working end **68** may include a distal or terminal end or portion **68a**. Regardless, the user **56** may engage the driver **54** to cause the working end **68** to engage a selected portion, such as a portion of a patient **70**.

(19) The instrument **52**, as discussed above, can be any appropriate instrument. In various

embodiments, the instrument **52** may include the working end **68** to include a tap, such as a tap to form a thread in a bore in a bone. Further, the working end **68** may include a terminal or distal end **68a**. The position of the working end **68** may be selected to be precisely known and/or determined. Thus, the tap at the working end **68** may be selected to be precisely and/or knowingly positioned relative to the patient **70**. For example, for forming and tapping a bore at a precise and/or preselected position for a bone screw. Further, an instrument **52'** may include a screw at the working end **68'**. It is understood, however, that any appropriate number of instruments may be provided with different or the same working end.

(20) In various embodiments, the selected position of the instrument **52** may be selected to be substantially precise, such as for positioning a pedicle screw, implant, deep brain stimulation probe, or the like. Accordingly, a determined position of the instrument **52** with the tracking system **32** may assist in navigation of the instrument **52** with the navigation system **34**. As discussed further herein, the position of the instrument **52** may be determined with the tracking system **32** and illustrated on a display device **72**, such as with an icon **52i**. The icon **52i** may illustrate the position of the instrument **52** relative to the patient **70** represented by an image **74**. The image **74** may also be displayed on the display device **72** and the icon **52i** may be superimposed thereon. The user **56** may, therefore, view the display device **72** to determine or view a representation of the instrument **52** relative to the patient **70** by viewing the icon **52i** relative to the image **74**.

(21) The instrument **52**, which may be a first instrument, may be substituted or changed to a different instrument, such as an instrument **52'**, also referred to as a second instrument **52'**. The instrument **52'** may include a working end **68'** that may be different than the working end **68**, and may include a screw which may be placed in the bore tapped with the tap **68**. In various embodiments, the working end **68** may include a tap which is formed and configured to tap a portion of the patient **70**, such as a vertebra, and the screw **68'** may be positioned in the tapped opening or bore. During a selected procedure, the instrument **52**, including the shaft **66**, may be removed from the handle **54** including the chuck **64**. A shaft **66'** of the instrument **52'** may then be positioned within the chuck **64** for driving the screw **68'** into the subject or patient **70**.

(22) The holder **10** may remain fixed to the handle **54**, with the connections as discussed herein, while the instrument **52** and/or **52'** is positioned or repositioned (e.g. passed through the holder **10**) to the handle **54**. For example, in various embodiments, the shaft **66** of the instrument **52** may be first connected to the handle **54**. At a selected time, such as after using the instrument **52** (e.g. to tap a bore), the shaft **66** may be withdrawn or removed through the extension or guide portion **24** of the holder **10** while the holder **10** remained attached to the handle **54**. Once the instrument **52** is removed, and the shaft **66'** of the instrument **52'** may be passed through the guide or shaft holder **24** into the chuck **64** in a reverse manner. While the instrument **52** is removed from the tool **54** and the instrument **52'** engaged therewith, the tracking device holder **10** may be maintained on the tool **54**. Accordingly, the instrument **52** need be the only portion or member removed from the tool **54** and the instrument **52'** positioned into the tool **54** without moving or changing the tracking device holder **10**. This can reduce the time of a procedure by, for example, eliminating calibration or recalibration of the holder **10** with the trackable members relative to the handle **54** after changing an instrument relative to the handle **54**.

(23) To assist in holding or to maintain fixation of the holder **10** to the handle **54**, in various embodiments, the holder **10** may include a tool or handle engagement mechanism at the tool engagement portion **16**. For example, a friction engagement or holding member **80** is positioned within a receiving groove or portion **82** of the tracking device holder **10**. The friction member **80** may include an O-ring formed of a selected material, such as a butyl rubber or other synthetic or natural rubber material. The ring **80** may extend or project from the groove **82** and engage an external surface or a portion of the tool **54**. The engagement of the holding member **80** with the tool **54**, such as the friction engagement, may not be overcome by movement of the instrument **52**, **52'** through the guide portion **24**.

(24) The tracking device holder **10** may be positioned at selected and fixed positions relative to the tool **54** through engagement of one or more indents **90** formed as depressions or passages in an end wall **92** and having an internal wall **94**. The internal wall **94** of the indent or groove **90** may engage a holding pin **98** that extends from the tool **54**. The holder **10** may then be positioned at a selected rotational position around an axis **100** extending through the tool **54**. As illustrated in FIG. **1**, the tracking device holder **10** may include six indents or positions **90** at the tool engaging portion **16**. It is understood that more or fewer indents or positional members may be provided with the tracking device holder **10**. Regardless, the holder **10** may be oriented such that when pressed on the handle **54** the pin **98** will be received within the indent **90** to rotationally fix the holder **10** relative to the handle **54**. It is understood, however, that the handle **54** may include one or more depressions that receive a pin or projection of the holder **10**.

(25) The tracking members **30** may be placed generally on a plane **102** or on a selected side of the plane **102**. The plane **102** may be defined by at least a portion of the holder **10**. Thus, the holder **10** may rotate to rotate the plane around the axis **100** and be held in the selected position relative to the handle **54**. The plane **102**, therefore, may be positioned in a selected, e.g. optimal view or line of sight of the localizer **38**.

(26) The engagement feature or mechanism **80** may include alternative and/or additional engagement features. For example, the tool engagement portion **16** may include an internal thread that engages an external thread defined or formed by the tool **54**. The holder **10** may then be threaded onto the tool **54**. Further, or alternatively thereto, a quick connect mechanism may be provided to engage the tracking device holder **10** with the tool **54**. For example, a holding member or ball may be retracted into the tool **54** when engaged by the tracking device holder **10** and then rebound or be biased into the holding portion or groove **82** in the tracking device holder **10** when the tracking device holder **10** is positioned at a selected position relative to the tool **54**.

Accordingly, it is understood, that the tracking device holder **10** may be held relative to the tool **54** in any appropriate manner. Further, the tracking device holder **10** may be positioned at a selected rotational position relative to the tool **54** and held at the selected position.

(27) As discussed further herein tracking the tool **54** and/or the instrument **52**, **52'** may require that the tracking devices **30** be positioned at a fixed and known position relative to the tool **54** and/or the instrument **52**, **52'**. Accordingly, the tracking device holder **10** may hold the tracking devices **30** at a fixed and selected position relative to the tool **54** during a procedure. Prior to tracking the instrument **52**, **52'** (e.g. during a procedure), the tracking devices **30** may be calibrated or registered relative to a portion of the instrument **52** (e.g. the working end **68** and/or the terminal end **68a**) and/or the tool **54**. In various embodiments, calibration may occur with a fiducial or fixed/known point registration procedure as is generally understood in the art.

(28) For example, calibration may occur by tracking the holder **10**, including the tracking devices **30**, positioned on the tool **54**. With or without the instrument **52**, **52'** positioned within the tool **54**, the positions of the tracking devices **30** relative to the tool **54** may be determined. For example, the holder **10** may engage a selected feature, such as a divot, at a known position relative to the localizer **38**. The navigation system **34** may then determine the position of the tracking devices **30** relative to the tool **54**. The instrument **52**, **52'** may then be engaged with the tool **54** and the navigation system **34** may recall from a navigation memory **110** a geometry of the instrument **52**, **52'**. The navigation system **34** may then, knowing the geometry of the instrument **52**, **52'** and the position of the tracking devices **30** relative to the tool **54**, determine the position of the working end **68**, **68'** based upon the known geometry of the respective tools **52**, **52'**. It is further understood that the user **56** may enter a geometry of the instruments **52**, **52'** rather than having them recalled from the navigation memory **110**.

(29) Regardless, the tracking device holder **10** is used to fixedly hold the tracking devices **30** relative to the tool **54** and/or the instrument **52**, **52'**. Thus, the user **56** need not directly engage the holder **10**. Further, the geometry of the tracking device holder **10** allows for the instrument **52** to be

engaged and disengaged from the tool **54** and the instrument **52'** to be engaged and disengaged from the tool **54** without removing the tracking device holder **10** or moving the tracking device holder **10** relative to the tool **54**. Therefore, once the tracking device holder **10** and the tracking devices **30** positioned therewith are registered or calibrated relative to the tool **54** the instrument may be changed relative to the tool **54** without requiring recalibration of the position of the tracking devices relative to the tool and/or with the respective instruments **52**, **52'**.

(30) The selected instrument **52**, **52'** (or other appropriate instrument), therefore, may be used to perform a procedure on the subject **70**. In various embodiments, with reference to FIG. **4**, therefore, the tracking device holder **10** is used by the user **56** to position and/or navigate the instrument **52** relative to the subject **70**. For example, the instrument may include a tap at the working end **68** to tap (e.g. form threads in a bore) in a selected portion of the subject **70** including a vertebrae **120**. The image **74** may include an image of the vertebrae **120** as a vertebrae image **124**. The icon **52i** may be illustrated on the display device **72** relative to the image **124**.

(31) The navigation system **34** may be used for various purposes or procedures by one or more users, such as the user **56**. The navigation system **56** may be used to determine or track a position of the instrument **52** in a volume, such as the navigation or tracking volume **48**. Tracking the position of the instrument **52** may assist the user **56** in determining a position of the instrument **162** even if the instrument **52** is not directly viewable by the user **56**. Various procedures may block the view of the user **56**, such as performing a repair or assembling an inanimate system, such as a robotic system, assembling portions of an airframe or an automobile, or the like. Various other procedures may include a surgical procedure, such as performing a spinal procedure, neurological procedure, positioning a deep brain stimulation probe, or other surgical procedures on a living subject. In various embodiments, for example, the living subject may be a human subject **70** and the procedure may be performed on the human subject **70**. It is understood, however, that the instrument **52** may be tracked and/or navigated relative to any subject for any appropriate procedure.

(32) Nevertheless, in various embodiments, the surgical navigation system **34**, as discussed further herein, may incorporate various portions such as those disclosed in U.S. Pat. Nos. RE44,305; 7,697,972; 8,644,907; and 8,842,893; and U.S. Pat. App. Pub. Nos. 2004/0199072, all incorporated herein by reference. Various components that may be used with or as a component of the surgical navigation system **34** may include an imaging system **130** that is operable to image the subject **70**, such as an O-arm® imaging system, magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) system, computed tomography system, etc. A subject support **132** may be used to support or hold the subject **70** during imaging and/or during a procedure. The same or different supports may be used for different portions of a procedure.

(33) Image data may be acquired during a surgical procedure or acquired prior to a surgical procedure for displaying the image **74** on the display device **72**. The instrument **52** may be tracked in the trackable volume or the navigational volume **48** that is defined by the tracking system, including the localizer **38**, **40**. The position of the instrument **52** may be tracked in the tracking volume relative to the subject **70** and then illustrated as the icon **52i** with the display device **72**. In various embodiments, the icon **52i** may be superimposed on the image **74** and/or adjacent to the image **74**. As discussed herein, the navigation system **34** may incorporate the display device **72** and operate to render the image **74** from selected image data, display the image **74**, determine the position of the instrument **52**, determine the location of the icon **52i**, etc.

(34) In various embodiments, the localizer **46** may be an electro-magnetic (EM) localizer that is operable to generate electro-magnetic fields with a transmitting coil array (TCA) **42** which is incorporated into the localizer **46**. The TCA **42** may include one or more coil groupings or arrays. In various embodiments, more than one group is included and each of the groupings may include three coils, also referred to as trios or triplets. The coils may be powered to generate or form an electro-magnetic field by driving current through the coils of the coil groupings. As the current is

driven through the coils, the electro-magnetic fields generated will extend away from the coils **42** and form the navigation domain or volume **48**, such as encompassing all or a portion of the subject **70**, including spinal vertebrae **120**, or other appropriate portion. The coils may be powered through a TCA controller and/or power supply **136**.

(35) The navigation domain or volume **48** may also be defined by a volume or area that is viewable by cameras of the localizer **38**. In various embodiments a selected number of cameras (e.g. two cameras **38a**, **38b**) may view the volume **48**. The volume viewable by the localizer **38** may include the navigation volume **48**. The position of the tracking device or trackable members **30** may be determined relative to a patient tracker **140**, that is also viewable, or relative to the localizer **38** (e.g. if the localizer **38** is fixed relative to the subject **70**).

(36) The navigation domain or volume **48** generally defines a navigation space or patient space. As is generally understood in the art, the instrument **52**, such as discussed above, may include a drill, lead, etc., may be tracked in the navigation domain relative to a patient or subject **70** with the tracking assembly **10** including the trackable members **30**. For example, the instrument **52** may be freely moveable, such as by the user **56**, relative to the dynamic reference frame (DRF) or reference frame tracker **140** that is fixed relative to the subject **70**. Both the tracking devices **10**, **140** may include trackable members **30** and/or tracking or sensing coils (e.g. conductive material formed as a coil) that sense and are used to measure a magnetic field strength, etc. Due to the tracking device **10** connected or associated with the instrument **52**, relative to the DRF **140**, the navigation system **30** may be used to determine the position of the instrument **52** relative to the DRF **140**.

(37) The navigation volume or patient space may be registered to an image space of the patient and the icon **52i** representing the instrument **52** may be illustrated at a known and tracked location with the display device, such as superimposed on the image **74**. Registration of the patient space to the image space and determining a location of a tracking device, such as with the tracking device **10** relative to the DRF **140**, may be performed as generally known in the art, including as disclosed in U.S. Pat. Nos. RE44,305; 7,697,972; 8,644,907; and 8,842,893; and U.S. Pat. App. Pub. Nos. 2004/0199072, all incorporated herein by reference.

(38) The navigation system **34** may further include a navigation processor system **146**. The navigation processor system **146** may include the display device **72**, one or more of the localizers **38**, **40**, the TCA controller **136**, and other portions and/or connections thereto. For example, a wire connection may be provided between the TCA controller **136** and a navigation processing unit **148**. Further, the navigation processor system **146** may have one or more inputs, such as a keyboard **150**, and have and/or be in communication with one or more memory systems **110**, either integrated or via a communication system. The navigation processor system **146** may, according to various embodiments, include those disclosed in U.S. Pat. Nos. RE44,305; 7,697,972; 8,644,907; and 8,842,893; and U.S. Pat. App. Pub. Nos. 2004/0199072, all incorporated herein by reference, or may also include the commercially available StealthStation® or Fusion™ surgical navigation systems sold by Medtronic Navigation, Inc. having a place of business in Louisville, CO.

(39) Tracking information, including regarding the viewed and/or triangulated position of the tracking devices **10**, **140** may be delivered via a communication system, such as the TCA controller, which also may be a tracking device controller **136**, to the navigation processor system **146** including the navigation processor **148**. Navigation processor **148** may be a part of the work station or computer system **146** that includes the display device **72** to display the image **74**. Various other memory and processing systems may also be provided with and/or in communication with the processor system **148** such as an imaging processing unit **154**. The image processing unit **154** may be incorporated into the imaging system **130**, such as the O-arm® imaging system, as discussed above. The imaging system **130** may, therefore, include various portions such as a source and a x-ray detector that are moveable within a gantry **160**. The imaging system **130** may also be tracked with a tracking device **166**. It is understood, however, that the imaging system **130** need not

be present while tracking the tracking devices, including the instrument tracking device **10**. Also, the imaging system **130** may be any appropriate imaging system including a MRI, CT, etc.

(40) Information regarding all of the tracking devices may be communicated to the navigation processor **148** for determining a position of the tracked portions relative to each other and/or for localizing the instrument **52** relative to the image **74**. The imaging system **130** may be used to acquire image data to generate or produce the image **74** of the subject **70**. It is understood, however, that other appropriate imaging systems may also be used. The TCA controller **136** may be used to operate and power the TCA **46** and or the localizer **38**, as discussed above.

(41) In various embodiments, therefore, and with continuing reference to FIGS. **1-4**, the holder **10**, also referred to as the tracking device or assembly, may be tracked with the tracking system **32**, such as with the localizer **38**, to determine a position of the instrument **52** with the navigation system **34**. As discussed above, tracking may occur due to the tracking members **30** that are held by the holder **10** relative to the handle **54**. During a procedure, however, the instrument **52** and/or **52'** may be removed and replaced with the other of the instrument **52**, **52'** without removing the holder **10**. Thus, only the instrument **52**, **52'**; may be removed from the handle **54**. It is understood, however, that other additional instruments may also be positioned relative to the handle **54** after removing the exemplary disclosed instruments.

(42) As discussed above, the holder **10** including the trackable members **30** may be a registered and/or calibrated relative to the handle **54** prior to tracking any instruments and/or performing a procedure on the subject **70**. In various embodiments, therefore, the holder **10** may be fitted to the handle **54**, as discussed above, and then calibrated or registered. The calibration may include predetermining (e.g. during a manufacture) a geometry of the holder **10** and/or the members **30** relative to the handle **54** and saving the predetermined geometry. The predetermined geometry may then be recalled, such as by the user **56**, once assembling the holder **10** to the handle **54**. The navigation processing unit **148** may recall from the navigation memory **110** the predetermined geometry and use the recalled predetermined geometry for calibration of the holder **10** relative to the handle **54**. The geometry of the instrument, such as the instrument **52**, can also then be calibrated and/or recalled from the navigation memory **110** to be able to track the position of the instrument **52**, including the working end **68**.

(43) Alternatively, or in addition to a lookup table or recalling from memory, the tracking system **32** may be calibrated during use. For example, the holder **10** may be positioned or fit to the handle **54** in a selected manner, as discussed above. A portion of the holder **10**, once fitted to the handle **54**, may then be touched to a known or registerable portion, such as a divot formed by the DRF **140**. For example, a distal end of the holder or selected portion thereof, such as a projection **10c** may engage a divot (e.g. shaped indent in the DRF **140**). Once the distal end, for example the projection **10c**, engages the divot of the DRF **140** the tracking system **32** may be operated to calibrate or determine a position of the projection **10c** in the navigation volume **70**. Therefore during a procedure the geometry or position of at least a portion of the holder **10** may be determined during a procedure. Then the instrument **52** fixed to the handle **54** may also be touched to the divot of the DRF **140** to know the distal end of the working end **68** relative to the end or projection **10c** of the holder **10**.

(44) Upon removal of the instrument **52** and insertion of the instrument **52'**, the calibration of the holder **10** relative to the handle **54** need not be repeated, especially if and/or only if the holder **10** is not removed from the handle **54** during removal of the instrument **52** and/or insertion of the instrument **52'**. The instrument **52** may be removed through the holder **10** and the instrument **52'** may be inserted into the handle **54** through the holder **10**.

(45) Accordingly, the holder **10**, including the trackable members **30**, may be calibrated relative to the handle **54** at a single time and only one time, such as prior to a procedure or during a procedure. After the calibration, instruments may be removed and inserted, such as serially or sequentially, with the handle **54** without requiring recalibration of the holder **10** including the trackable members

30. Thus, the user 56 may select different instruments and attach the different instruments at selected different times to the handle 54 without requiring recalibration of the holder and the trackable members 30 to continue tracking and navigation of the selected instrument 52. Therefore the position (i.e. including a three dimensional location and selected degrees of freedom of orientation (three degrees of freedom)) may be made with the tracking system 32 to allow for navigation of the instrument 52 with the navigation system 34.

(46) Example embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough, and will fully convey the scope to those who are skilled in the art. Numerous specific details are set forth such as examples of specific components, devices, and methods, to provide a thorough understanding of embodiments of the present disclosure. It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that specific details need not be employed, that example embodiments may be embodied in many different forms and that neither should be construed to limit the scope of the disclosure. In some example embodiments, well-known processes, well-known device structures, and well-known technologies are not described in detail.

(47) The foregoing description of the embodiments has been provided for purposes of illustration and description. It is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the disclosure. Individual elements or features of a particular embodiment are generally not limited to that particular embodiment, but, where applicable, are interchangeable and can be used in a selected embodiment, even if not specifically shown or described. The same may also be varied in many ways. Such variations are not to be regarded as a departure from the disclosure, and all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A method of tracking a first instrument and a second instrument with a trackable member, the method comprising: forming a trackable member engagement portion of a tracking member holder that extends along a longitudinal axis from a proximal end to a distal end, the trackable member engagement portion configured to hold at least one trackable member of a plurality of trackable members; forming an instrument guiding portion at the distal end of the tracking member holder having an internal wall defining an instrument passage extending along the longitudinal axis to allow passage of the first instrument and the second instrument to connect to a handle; forming a handle engageable portion at the proximal end of the tracking member holder configured to removably hold the tracking member holder relative to the handle; and forming an extension axially extending along the longitudinal axis and positioned between the instrument guiding portion and the handle engageable portion; wherein the handle engageable portion is spaced apart from the instrument guiding portion with the extension.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: fixing a plurality of trackable members to the trackable member engagement portion.
3. The method of claim 2, further comprising: connecting the tracking member holder to the handle; and calibrating the tracking member holder relative to the handle.
4. The method of claim 3, further comprising: connecting the first instrument to the handle through the instrument guiding portion; and operating a tracking system to track at least one trackable member of the plurality of trackable members.
5. The method of claim 4, further comprising: removing the first instrument from connection with the handle while maintaining the connection of the tracking member holder to the handle; connecting the second instrument to the handle through the instrument guiding portion of the tracking member holder while connected to the handle.
6. The method of claim 5, further comprising: operating the tracking system to track at least one trackable member of the plurality of trackable members without calibrating the tracking member holder relative to the handle.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein forming includes molding the tracking member holder from a polymer material.
8. The method of claim 4, wherein connecting the first instrument to the handle includes passing the first instrument through the instrument guiding portion to couple to the handle spaced apart from the instrument guiding portion; and rotating the first instrument within the instrument guiding portion using the handle.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein forming the trackable member engagement portion includes forming a first trackable member engagement portion on the handle engageable portion, forming a second trackable member engagement portion on the instrument guiding portion, and forming a third trackable member engagement portion on the extension, wherein the first, second and third trackable member engagement portions is each configured to carry a trackable member.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein forming the handle engageable portion includes forming an annular shaped handle engageable portion that is annularly positioned about the longitudinal axis of the tracking member holder and configured to be removably attached to the handle.
11. The method of claim 10, further comprising forming a plurality of notches into the annular handle engageable portion, wherein each notch of the plurality of notches is configured to engage a protrusion of the handle to rotatably retain the tracking member holder relative to the handle.
12. The method of claim 1, wherein forming the extension further includes forming a u-shaped extension that axially extends between the handle engagement portion and the instrument guide portion.
13. The method of claim 1, wherein forming the instrument guiding portion further includes forming a pair of opposed buttresses extending from the instrument guiding portion and configured to provide support for the instrument guiding portion.
14. The method of claim 1, wherein forming the extension further includes forming a u-shaped extension having a pair of opposed wing members extending from the formed u-shaped extension, each wing member having a trackable member engagement portion configured to hold at least one trackable member.
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